DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

STUDENT DIGITAL AMBASSADOR PROJECT

PROJECT REPORT

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Registration Number: 25BCE11395

Course: Digital Literacy (CSE0001)

Faculty: Prof. Kanan

Institution: Vellore Institute of Technology, Bhopal

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1. Introduction

This project report documents the Digital Literacy Portfolio I have built as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The scenario guiding this assignment is that of a Student Digital Ambassador a peer leader responsible for helping fellow students navigate the digital world safely, professionally, and effectively.

The portfolio is structured around five tasks, each aligned with a module of the course: creating an awareness infographic, building a professional digital presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, practising professional email communication, and developing cybercrime awareness resources. All artefacts are organised in a single public GitHub repository, which is itself a demonstration of version-control skills introduced during the course.

This report presents my reflections on each task, the tools I chose, the challenges I encountered, and what I learned along the way.

2. Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used

I used Canva (canva.com) to design the infographic. Canva is a browser-based graphic design tool that requires no prior design experience, making it ideal for this task. It offers a large library of free templates, icons, and colour schemes, all of which I used to create a clean, professional layout.

Design and Content

My infographic is a single-page visual resource covering three main topics: what digital literacy is and why it matters for college students, useful free digital tools for academics such as Google

Workspace, Canva, and GitHub, and safe internet practices including strong password hygiene, recognising phishing links, and privacy settings. I used a consistent blue and white colour scheme to keep the layout readable and professional.

Reflection

The most challenging aspect of this task was balancing the amount of information with visual clarity. I initially tried to include all five suggested topics but quickly found that the infographic became too cluttered. I had to make deliberate choices about what to prioritise. What I found most interesting was discovering how much layout and colour choice affect whether a reader actually engages with the content good design is itself a form of digital communication.

3. Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up

I created and updated accounts on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

- GitHub (github.com): GitHub is a code hosting and version-control platform used by developers, students, and researchers worldwide. I created a profile README repository with my name, registration number, branch, and a brief statement about what I hope to learn during my B.Tech programme. I also created the repository for this Digital Literacy project and organised all task folders within it.
- LinkedIn (linkedin.com): LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform, used by employers, recruiters, and academics to connect and showcase experience. I completed my Education section with my current degree (B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering), institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year.
- Kaggle (kaggle.com): Kaggle is a platform for data science and machine learning competitions, datasets, and notebooks. As a CSE student, I set up my profile in anticipation of exploring data science projects in later semesters.

Reflection

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to host all my academic projects and eventually contribute to open-source repositories. LinkedIn will be important when I begin applying for internships in my second year. Kaggle will become more relevant once I take up courses in machine learning and data analysis. Setting up these profiles now — even with minimal content — means I am building a digital trail from day one.

4. Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice Platform

I created an account on HackerRank (hackerrank.com) and completed the introductory challenge 'Solve Me First,' which involves a basic input-output problem in a programming

language of the student's choice. I chose Python. The challenge helped me understand how online judges evaluate code submissions — a skill I will rely on heavily during placement preparation. A screenshot of the completed challenge and my score has been added to the task-3-platforms/ folder in my repository.

Part B – Google Form (Digital Literacy Quiz)

I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' intended for use with my batchmates. The form contains five questions covering topics across all five modules of this course. It includes at least one multiple-choice question and one short-answer question, as required.

Google Form Link:
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSet9otcQd_y57abv7fXtGqRJQGqiidj6Sl_3KAddWyBTu2LaA/viewform?usp=publish-editor

Screenshots of the form and the linked Google Sheet (response view) are stored in task-3-platforms/.

Reflection

Using HackerRank reinforced my understanding of how structured problem-solving works in a digital environment. Building the Google Form was a genuinely useful exercise — it forced me to think about what I actually learned in this course and how to translate that knowledge into questions a peer could engage with. I now see Google Forms as a lightweight but powerful tool for peer assessment, event registrations, and data collection in academic projects.

5. Task 4 – Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

Email 1 – Requesting Assignment Extension

Subject: Request for Extension – Assignment Submission Deadline

Dear Prof. kanan,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to respectfully request a short extension for the upcoming assignment submission deadline of 31st march. I have been unwell over the past two days and have been unable to complete the work to the standard I would like to submit. I have already completed approximately 70% of the assignment and am confident I can finish within 48 additional hours. I understand this is at your discretion and am happy to provide a medical certificate if required. Thank you very much for your time and consideration.

Yours sincerely,

Stutie Agrawaal | 25BCE11395 | B.Tech CSE, First Year | VIT Bhopal University

Email 2 – Internship Expression of Interest

Subject: Summer Internship ApplicationB.Tech CSE Student, VIT Bhopal

Dear sir/maam,

My name is Stutie Agrawaal, and I am a first-year B.Tech Computer Science and Engineering student at VIT Bhopal University (Reg. No. 25BCE11395). I am writing to express my interest in summer internship opportunities at [Company Name] for the upcoming vacation period. I am keen to gain practical exposure to [relevant field] and believe that an internship at your organisation would be an excellent opportunity to apply my academic learning in a professional environment. I am a quick learner, comfortable with digital tools, and eager to contribute meaningfully. I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss this further. Please find my GitHub profile attached for reference. Thank you for your time.

Warm regards,

Stutie Agrawaal | 25BCE11395 | B.Tech CSE | VIT Bhopal University

Social Media Do's and Don'ts

Do's:

- Keep your LinkedIn and GitHub profiles professional and up to date.
- Think before you post — consider how the content reflects on you professionally.
- Use strong, unique passwords for each social media account.
- Enable two-factor authentication on all platforms.
- Credit others when sharing their content or ideas.

Don'ts:

- Do not share personal information such as your address, phone number, or ID details publicly.
- Do not engage with or spread unverified news or rumours.
- Do not post content that is offensive, discriminatory, or harassing.
- Do not accept connection requests from people you do not know without verifying their identity.
- Do not use your professional profile for informal or personal rants.

Reflection

A frequently cited real-world example involves employees who post complaints about their workplace on public social media, only to have those posts discovered by their employer or future hiring managers. In one such scenario, a student intern posted sarcastic comments about a company's work culture on a public Twitter account during their internship, not realising the company monitored social media. The internship was terminated as a result. The situation could have been avoided by keeping the account private, refraining from posting about the workplace, or addressing concerns through appropriate internal channels rather than public social media.

6. Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

Cybercrime Type: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

Case Study

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is one of the most rapidly growing cybercrimes in India, particularly targeting students and young adults who have recently started using digital payment apps. The crime typically unfolds in the following steps.

A fraudster contacts the victim — usually via phone or SMS — posing as a bank representative, a telecom agent, or a fellow student selling second-hand goods. The fraudster claims there is a problem with the victim's account or offers a deal that requires an advance payment. They then send a payment request (not a payment) through a UPI app such as PhonePe or Google Pay, framing it as a 'verification payment' or 'KYC update.' The victim, unfamiliar with the distinction between sending and receiving money, enters their UPI PIN to 'receive' the money, which instead authorises a debit from their account.

Victims are often students aged 18–22 who have recently set up UPI accounts and are not yet aware that entering a PIN always authorises a payment out, never a payment in. Consequences include immediate financial loss ranging from a few hundred to several thousand rupees, and significant psychological distress. Since UPI transactions are often irreversible, recovery is difficult.

Prevention Checklist – Stay Safe Online

- Never share your UPI PIN with anyone — not even bank officials or customer support agents.
- Remember: you do NOT need to enter a PIN to receive money. If asked to do so, it is a scam.
- Verify the identity of anyone requesting a payment before transferring funds.
- Enable transaction limits and notifications in your UPI app so you are alerted to every debit.
- Do not click on links received via SMS, WhatsApp, or email that ask you to log in to your bank or UPI app.
- Use only official apps from the Play Store or App Store — avoid third-party UPI apps.
- Set a strong, unique lock screen PIN and enable biometric authentication on payment apps.
- If you suspect fraud, report it immediately at cybercrime.gov.in or call Helpline 1930 (available 24x7).

Reflection

What surprised me most during my research was how technically simple UPI fraud actually is. There is no hacking involved — the entire attack relies on social engineering and exploiting the

victim's unfamiliarity with how UPI requests work. The distinction between a payment request and a payment link is subtle, and fraudsters exploit exactly that confusion. As a result of this research, I have made it a personal habit to always verify the name and UPI ID of anyone sending me a request before taking any action, and I have enabled transaction notifications for every debit from my linked account.

7. Conclusion

This project has been a practical and genuinely useful introduction to the digital skills that any first-year student needs to navigate university life and prepare for a professional career. Across five tasks, I have built an infographic, established a professional digital identity, practised on a coding platform, drafted professional emails, and developed an awareness resource on cybercrime.

The GitHub repository that holds all of this work is, in itself, a demonstration of digital literacy — version control, file organisation, and public documentation are skills that will stay relevant throughout my engineering degree. I look forward to adding to this portfolio as I progress through my programme.

8. References

- Canva Design Platform – canva.com
- GitHub – github.com
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com
- Kaggle – kaggle.com
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal – cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline – 1930 (Government of India, 24x7)
- VIT Bhopal University – vitbhopal.ac.in
- Project GitHub Repository – github.com/stutieagrawaal-glitch/vityarthi-digitalliteracy